



UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO  
**STUDENTS' UNION**



# UTSU Food Bank

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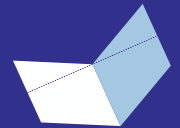
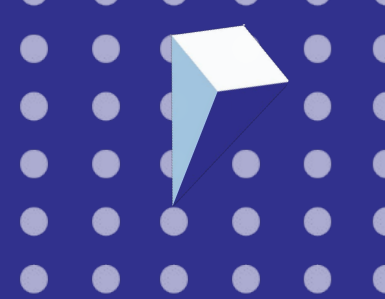
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Community Resource Specialist



# Outline

- Current Food Bank Overview
- Evaluation Findings
- University & College Food Banks Research Findings
- Proposed Food Bank Models
- Future Food Bank Model Recommendation
- Brainstorming / Discussion Session





# UTSU Food Bank



Opened in **2001**, the UTSU Food Bank addresses **food insecurity** on the St. George Campus. It is a **free, year round, service** that provides support to students - including students with families.

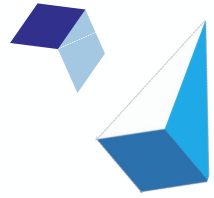
## OBJECTIVES

- To ensure students have food in their cupboards
- Protect and maintain student confidentiality and privacy
- Address hunger as a health and wellness issue
- Accommodate different dietary and cultural needs (where possible)
- Provide a safe environment for student clients, staff, and volunteers





# UTSU Food Bank



- Hybrid Hamper/Shopping Model
- Open to all UofT - St. George Campus students, including individuals and families with kids and dependents
- All students must sign up for a Daily Bread Client ID number
- Online appointment bookings open on Wednesdays at 9:30 am.
- Weekly service runs on Fridays from 11 am-3 pm.
- One appointment per week





# UTSU Food Bank

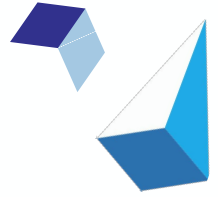


- Food deliveries from Daily Bread (weekly) and Second Harvest (bi-weekly) of which we are a member agency of
- Non-perishable food donations and monetary donations
- Food delivery is received and put away by CRS and volunteers on Wednesdays
- Food is stored in fridges, freezer, and on shelves in Room 136 (Food Bank), B168 (Commercial Kitchen), and B154 (Programs Team Storage)





# UTSU Food Bank

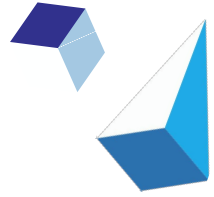


- Pre-packed, labeled client bags are organized on tables by appointment time
- Students need to bring valid T-card or current UofT timetable
- We check student registration status on ACORN
- Proxies are allowed
- Accommodations are provided





# UTSU Food Bank



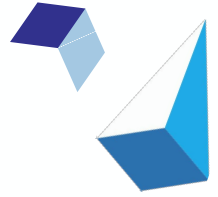
## SERVICE DAY - FRIDAY

- Before service, client bags are pre-packed.
- A self-serve section is prepared before the service begins.
- Once the clients arrive they present their TCard/ID and they are checked-in
- Students receive two bags of food (pasta, canned goods, rice, breakfast items, plus extra non-perishables/produce).





# UTSU Food Bank



## SERVICE DAY - FRIDAY

- During service, students select options for dairy, meat, additional produce, and items from the self-serve section.
- Any leftover perishables (e.g., produce) are donated
- After the service, all the bins and the fridges are cleaned and sanitized.







# UTSU Food Bank



## STAFFING / VOLUNTEER TEAM

- 1 Coordinator
- 2 CRS on every food bank shift
- 9 volunteers recruited each semester
- On Wednesday, 2 CRS and 4 volunteers.
- On Friday, 2 CRS and 5 volunteers.





# UTSU Food Bank



## LIMITATIONS

- Space limitation in Room 136
  - We can only serve maximum 2 clients at a time
  - Need to use extra fridges and freezers in B168 and B154
    - Delays service to clients
  - Limited space for staff, volunteers, and clients to move around
- First floor location doesn't give much privacy and can lead to line-ups





# UTSU Food Bank



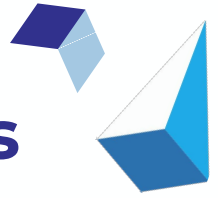
## LIMITATIONS

- Limited client autonomy when selecting food during their appointment and having to choose items being offered in front of other clients
- Staff and volunteer capacity is needed to build out bags
- Clients spend time going through bags and taking items out that they don't need or want





# UTSU Food Bank - Evaluation Findings



- Impact Feedback Surveys conducted in March & April
- 100% of our 44 survey respondents indicated that they are satisfied with the food bank service.
- Of this, 90% of the respondents indicated that they are very satisfied or extremely satisfied with the service.





# UTSU Food Bank - Evaluation Findings



## What's Working:

- Clients are happy with the variety of food that they receive
- We are providing food essentials that help students get through the week
- Eases the financial burden faced by our clients
- Reduces a lot of stress associated with food costs which makes it easier for them to focus on school





# UTSU Food Bank - Evaluation Findings



## Recommendations from Clients:

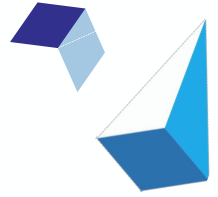
- Increase the number of service days
- Increase the number of appointment slots
- Use a bigger space to serve more clients at a time
- More promotion about the food bank service
- Having a food bank drop-in service





# University & College Food Banks

## Research Findings



- **Environmental scan of 38 schools with food banks across Canada**
- **Varying types of food bank models**
  - **Grocery Shopping Model - using points or limits**
  - **Pantry Model**
  - **Food Hamper Model**
  - **Food Lockers Model**
  - **Grocery Gift Cards Model**





## Model 1: Hybrid Hamper/Grocery Shopping

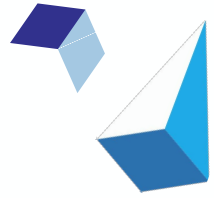
- Current UTSU Food Bank model comprised of pre-packed hampers and clients choosing food during their appointment with some limits
- **UBC** - hybrid hamper/grocery shopping model, open to all students, 2 days/week, 1 app/week (max 16 visits/semester)
- **University of Calgary** - hybrid hamper/grocery shopping model, 3 visits/semester, open to all students, 6 days/week
- **Centennial** - hybrid hamper grocery store, 1 visit every 7 days or 1 visit every 14 days, depending on which of 3 campuses visited
- **UVic** - hamper model, open to all students, 3 days/week, 1 app/week
- **Memorial** - hamper model, open to all students, 2 days/week, 1 app every 4 weeks







# Model 1: Hybrid Hamper/Grocery Shopping



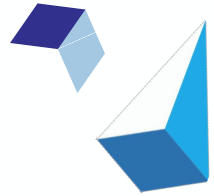
## PROS

- Our hybrid model gives clients the chance to select the food they need based on what is being offered
- Clients receive a balanced, predetermined supply of non-perishable staples.
- Customized to accommodate dietary restrictions or family sizes.
- Provides an equitable and dignified approach (e.g., more food to student families)
- Hampers – Reduced wait times for clients in line and may have few items that need refrigerators.





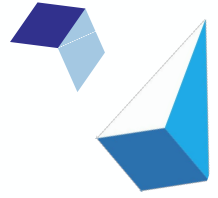
# Model 1: Hybrid Hamper/Grocery Shopping



## CONS

- Building out hampers requires more storage space and it takes more staff/volunteer capacity
- Appointments take longer as clients have to go through bags and take items out and have to take time to choose items being offered
- Hampers lacks autonomy as whatever is pre-packed is what the clients get to take home, even when they may not need it, this may lead to food waste
- Uses paper bags - not sustainable and cost effective





## Model 2: Pantry Model

- **Trent U** - One-Stop Chop Food Pantry, open to all students, 5 days/week, 30 min apps, 1 app every 2 weeks
- **George Brown** - Student Nutrition Access Program, pantry model, all 3 campuses, open to all George Brown students, 5 days/week, 1 visit/week at any of the campuses
- **Western** - Food Support Services, pantry model, 5 days/week, 1 visit every 2 weeks, open to undergraduate students only



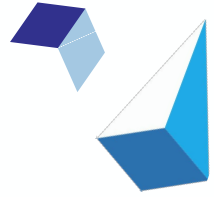


## Model 2: Pantry Model

### PROS

- Allows individuals to select their own food items rather than receiving a pre-packed hamper or food box
- Reduced food waste as clients only take what they actually need
- Requires less staff and volunteers to operate
- Can be easily done as a drop-in service without appointments required



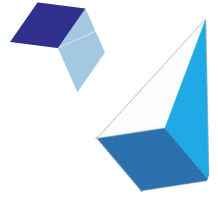


## Model 2: Pantry Model

### CONS

- Most pantries consist of non-perishable foods and canned items leading to not much food choice
- Reduced access to more costly food items (meats, dairy, eggs) as pantries often don't have fridges/freezers
- Pantries have limited items clients can take depending on weekly food inventory





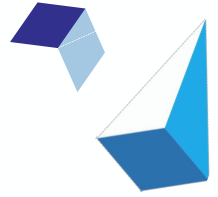
## Model 3: Grocery Shopping Model

- **TMU** – Good Food Centre; grocery shopping model with quantity limits; no apps – first-come, first-served; 4 days/week (reduced summer hours), open to all students; FT Coordinator and 3 PT staff
- **U of A** – Campus Food Bank; grocery shopping model; 1 app every 2 weeks; 30 min apps (no drop-ins); serve students, faculty, staff and alumni; transitioned to this model in 2022; run 6 days/week with 5 FT staff
- **Mount Saint Vincent University** – Food Bank; free grocery store model; 2 days/week; open to all students; drop-in (no apps); food item limits; no visit limits





# Model 3: Grocery Shopping Model



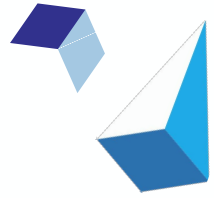
## PROS

- Dignified, equitable, and autonomous service
- Reduces food waste
- Easier to accommodate dietary needs
- Allows more clients to be served at the same time depending on space





# Model 3: Grocery Shopping Model

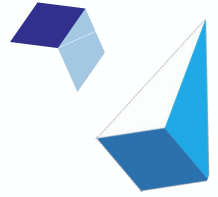


## CONS

- A bigger space is needed to operate this model like a grocery store
- More staff and volunteer oversight needed to operate the service (i.e., stock shelves, help clients, and monitor inventory)
- Drop-in service can lead to long line-ups
- Longer appointment times required as clients need to take their time to shop



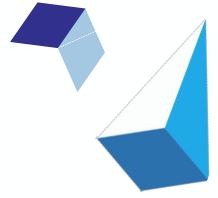




# Meetings

- Met with Rob from TMU Good Food Centre (GFC) and did tour of their space to learn more about the GFC and how we can adapt aspects of it to our future food bank
- Met with Madi from Campus Food Bank at the University of Alberta to learn more about about their transition from a hamper model to a grocery shopping model in 2022
- Marco attended Daily Bread Member Conference where he learned about various food bank models that different food banks use and their service delivery.

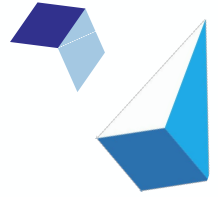




# TMU Good Food Centre

- Grocery shopping model that operates on first come first serve drop-in basis
- Daily Bread food delivery received on Tuesday
- Operate on Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday, with Tuesday being their busiest day with the most robust food selection for clients.
- Grocery items are placed on shelves and in 2 glass-door fridges, 1 glass-door freezer, and 1 chest freezer
- Students check-in, do their shopping for ~10-15 mins, and leave.



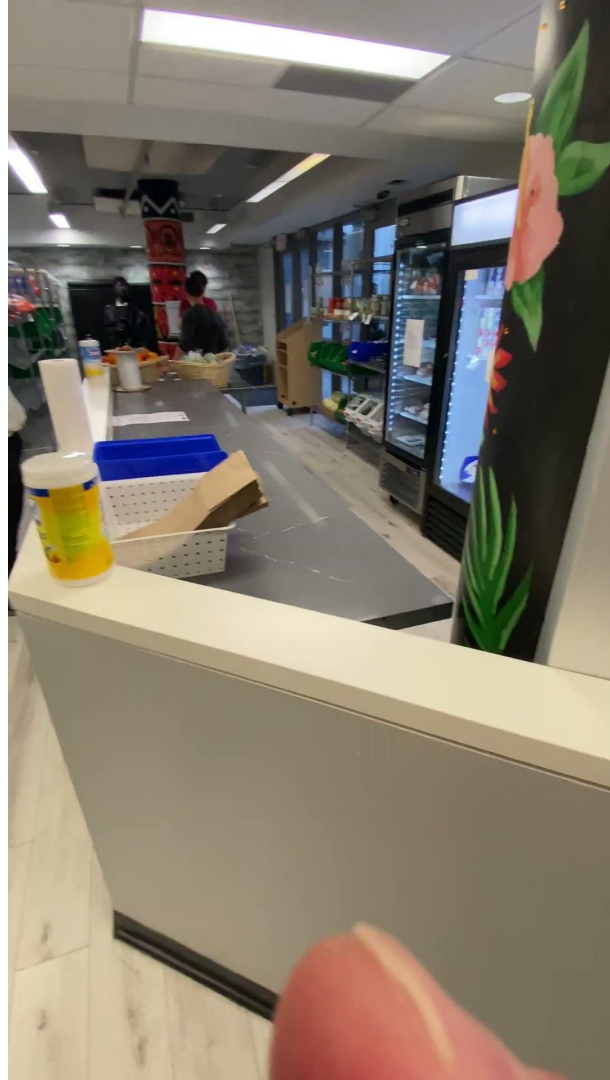
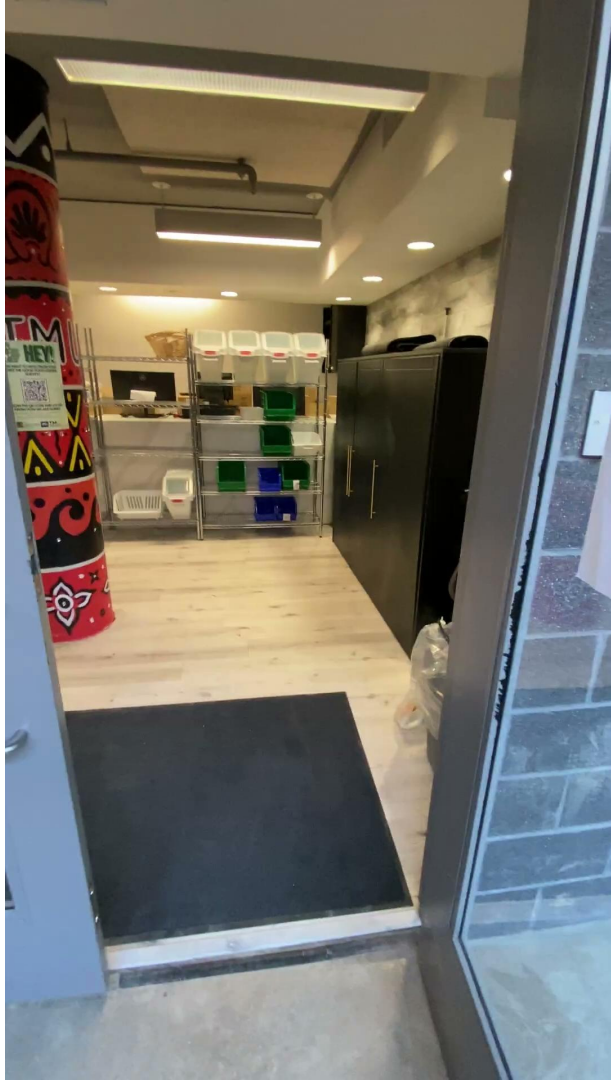


# TMU Good Food Centre

- Only 3 clients are allowed in at a time
- Items are replenished as they run out during service
- Limits are placed on popular or limited items (like milk, eggs, meat, bread, and certain produce) and are adjusted during service depending on supply and demand.
- TMU purchases eggs, milk, bread 1-2x/week to supplement their stock
- New members complete an intake process and receive a member card









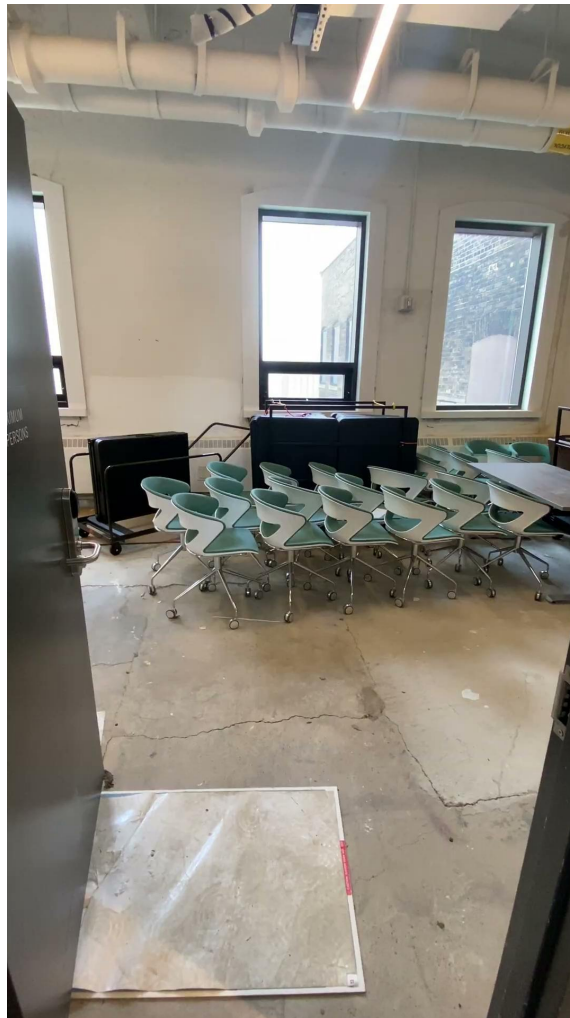






# Room 521

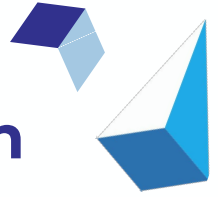
## Tour







# Future Food Bank Model Recommendation

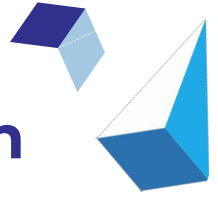


- The goal of model-changing is to increase the efficiency of the service, to serve more clients, and make it easier for UofT students to use the service.
- We are proposing that our new food bank operates using a Grocery Shopping Model.
- This model involves giving clients weekly points that they will then use to do their shopping in the food bank.
- 1 appointment per week and clients will be able to shop using the maximum number of points they have available to use each week





# Future Food Bank Model Recommendation



## Rationale for the New Food Bank Grocery Shopping Model:

- We will be able to serve more students as we can allow up to 3 students in at a time
- We will be able to increase the number of service days by adding two extra service days (i.e., one appointment day and one drop-in service day)
- Increase the number of appointment slots
- Increased client autonomy when selecting food during their appointment





# Future Food Bank Model Recommendation



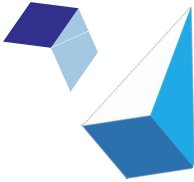
## **Wish list of things we will need if we are going to run a grocery shopping model:**

- More staff and volunteers
- We may need to purchase supplemental food depending on the increase in clients
- It would be great if we had glass door fridges and freezers so we can easily restock items when needed
- If we had a choice of designing the space we can perhaps use the TMU GFC's layout as it allows for efficient service flow and clients to move around





# Current vs Future Food Bank

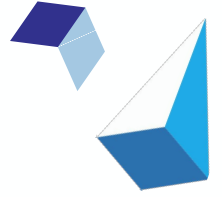


## Current Food bank

- 1 Service day
- 2 CRS per shift and total of 9 Volunteers
- Serving 55 Clients a week
- Maximum 2 clients at a time
- Less client autonomy
- Potential for food waste
- No need to purchase food

## Future Food bank

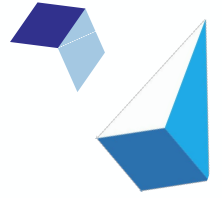
- 2 Service days + 1 drop-in day
  - Will need more CRS and volunteers
  - Serving up to 110 Clients a week
  - Maximum 3 clients at a time
  - More client autonomy
  - Reduced potential for food waste
  - May need to purchase supplemental food
- 



# Brainstorming / Discussion for New Proposed Model

- Do you have any questions or feedback about our new proposed model?

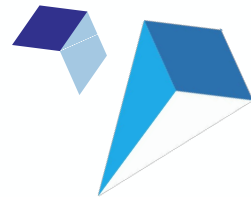




# Brainstorming / Discussion for New Proposed Model

- What are your thoughts about renaming the food bank?





**THANK YOU!**

